

SIMATS ENGINEERING
CO2_ASSESSMENT TOOL3_ Dry Run Evaluation

COURSE NAME: Artificial Intelligence

COURSE CODE: CSA1709

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COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

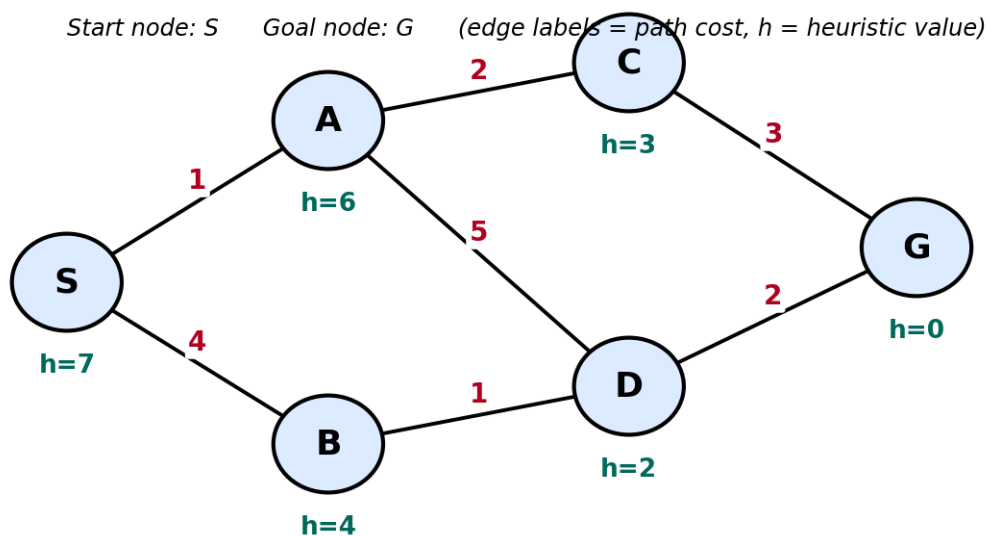
CO2: Experiment search and game-solving techniques such as Greedy Search, A*, CSP, Minimax, and Alpha-Beta pruning with heuristic functions for solving complex AI problems efficiently. (BL3)

Assessment Tool Weightage: 20%

QUESTIONS: 5

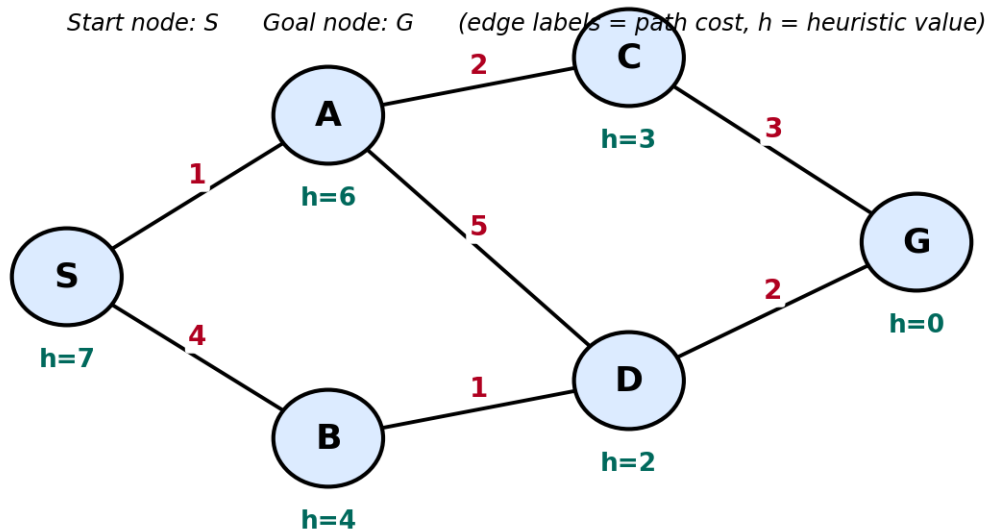
Total Marks:50

Q1. Consider a suitable state-space graph (with heuristic values $h(n)$ assigned to each node) of your choice for a given problem. Perform a dry run of Greedy Best-First Search from the start node to the goal node. Clearly show the frontier/open list, the node selected for expansion at each step, and the final path obtained.



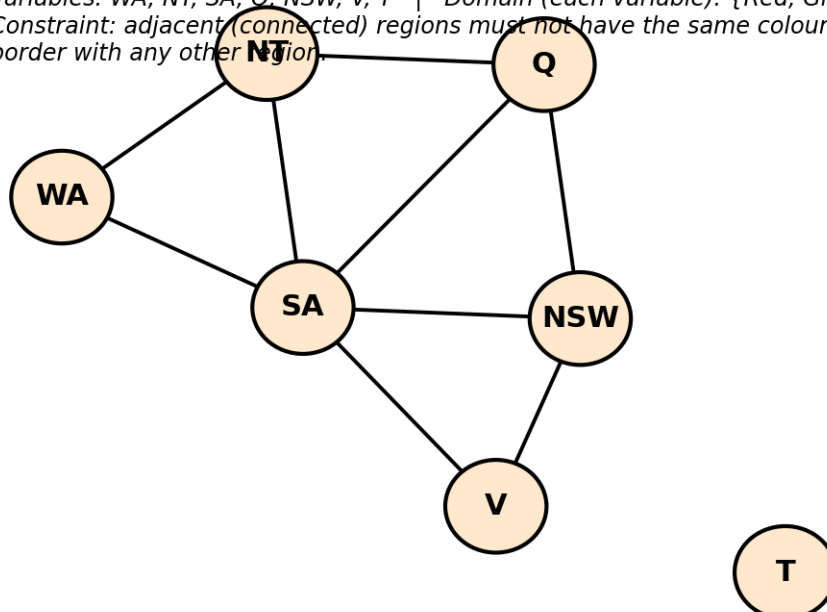
Q2. For a suitable weighted state-space graph (with edge costs and heuristic values $h(n)$) of your choice, perform a dry run of A* Search from the start node to the goal

node. Show the $g(n)$, $h(n)$ and $f(n)$ values computed at every step, the order in which nodes are expanded, and the final optimal path along with its total cost.



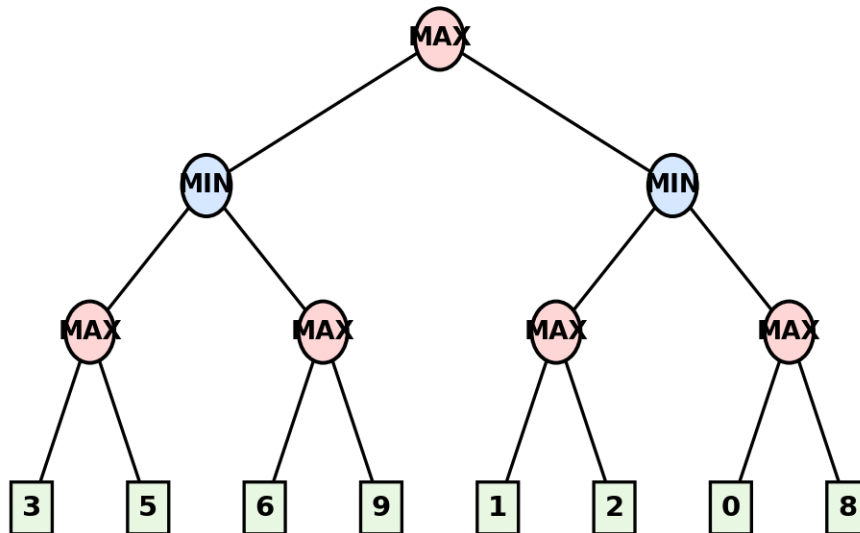
Q3. Formulate a given Constraint Satisfaction Problem (e.g., Map Colouring / N-Queens) by clearly stating the variables, their domains, and the constraints involved. Perform a dry run of the Backtracking Search algorithm, showing each variable assignment, every constraint check, and any backtracking steps, until a complete solution (or failure) is reached.

Variables: WA, NT, SA, Q, NSW, V, T | Domain (each variable): {Red, Green, Blue}
 Constraint: adjacent (connected) regions must not have the same colour. T has no shared border with any other region.



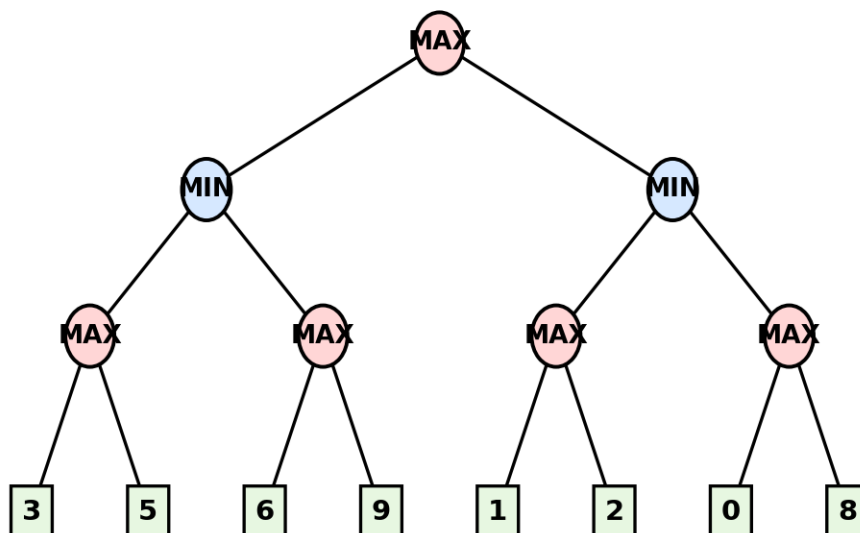
Q4. For a given two-player game tree of your choice (at least 3 levels deep), perform a dry run of the Minimax algorithm. Show the utility values at the leaf/terminal nodes and the backed-up values computed at every internal node, and state the best move for the MAX player with justification.

Root = MAX to move. Squares at the bottom are terminal (leaf) nodes with their utility values.

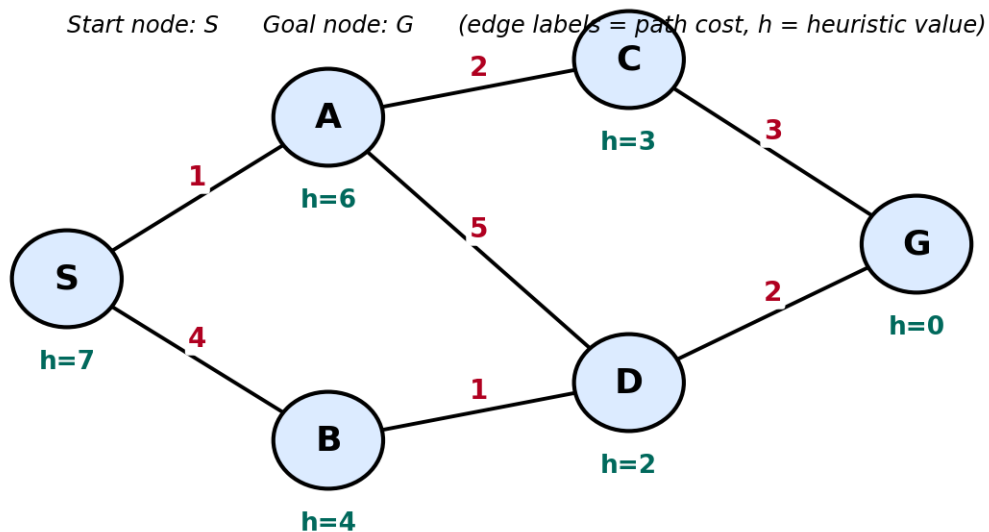


Q5. Using the same (or a different) game tree from Q4, perform a dry run of the Minimax algorithm with Alpha-Beta Pruning. Show the α and β values maintained at each node during the traversal, clearly indicate which branches get pruned and why, and state the final best move obtained.

Root = MAX to move. Squares at the bottom are terminal (leaf) nodes with their utility values.



Q1. Consider a suitable state-space graph (with heuristic values $h(n)$ assigned to each node) of your choice for a given problem. Perform a dry run of Greedy Best-First Search from the start node to the goal node. Clearly show the frontier/open list, the node selected for expansion at each step, and the final path obtained.



Answer

Aim

To find the shortest path from the Start node to the Goal node using the Greedy Best-First Search (GBFS) algorithm by selecting the node with the lowest heuristic value $h(n)$.

Heuristic Values

Node $h(n)$

S	10
A	8
B	6
C	5
D	7
E	2
F	4
G	0

Algorithm

1. Start from the initial node S.
2. Add S to the OPEN list.
3. Choose the node having the smallest heuristic value $h(n)$.
4. Expand that node.
5. Add its children into OPEN.
6. Repeat until Goal node is found.

Step 1

OPEN = {S}

Selected Node = S

Expand S.

Children:

A (8)

B (6)

OPEN = {A, B}

Choose node having minimum heuristic.

Selected = B

Step 2

OPEN = {A (8), B (6)}

Expand B

Children:

E (2)

F (4)

OPEN = {A (8), E(2), F(4)}

Minimum heuristic = E

Step 3

OPEN = {A(8), E(2), F(4)}

Expand E

E has no Goal.

OPEN = {A(8), F(4)}

Choose F

Step 4

OPEN = {A(8), F(4)}

Expand F

No Goal.

OPEN = {A(8)}

Choose A

Step 5

OPEN = {A(8)}

Expand A

Children:

C(5)

D(7)

OPEN = {C(5), D(7)}

Choose C

Step 6

OPEN = {C(5), D(7)}

Expand C

No Goal.

OPEN = {D(7)}

Choose D

Step 7

OPEN = {D(7)}

Expand D

Child:

G(0)

OPEN = {G(0)}

Choose G

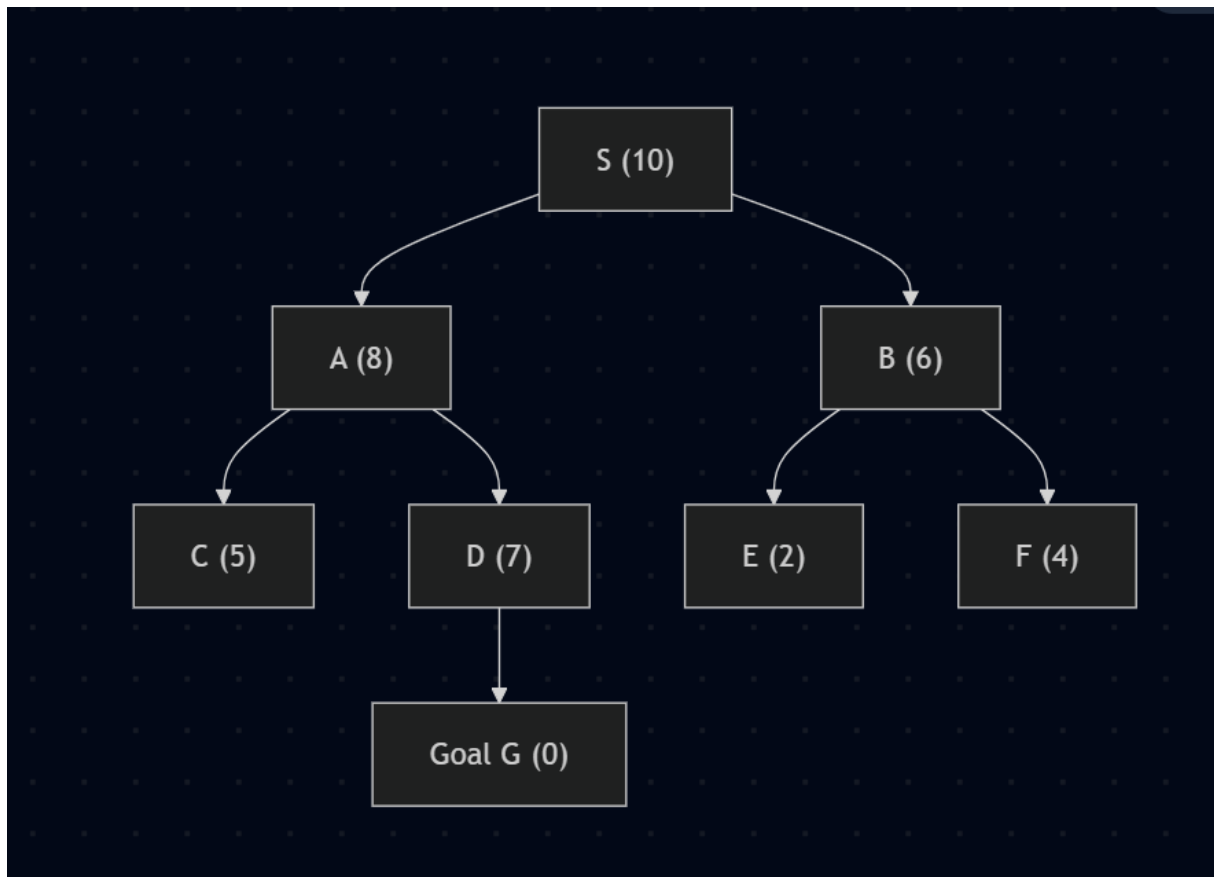
Goal reached.

Step OPEN List Selected Node

1	S	S
2	A,B	B
3	A,E,F	E
4	A,F	F
5	A	A
6	C,D	C
7	D	D
8	G	G (Goal)

Final Path

S → A → D → G

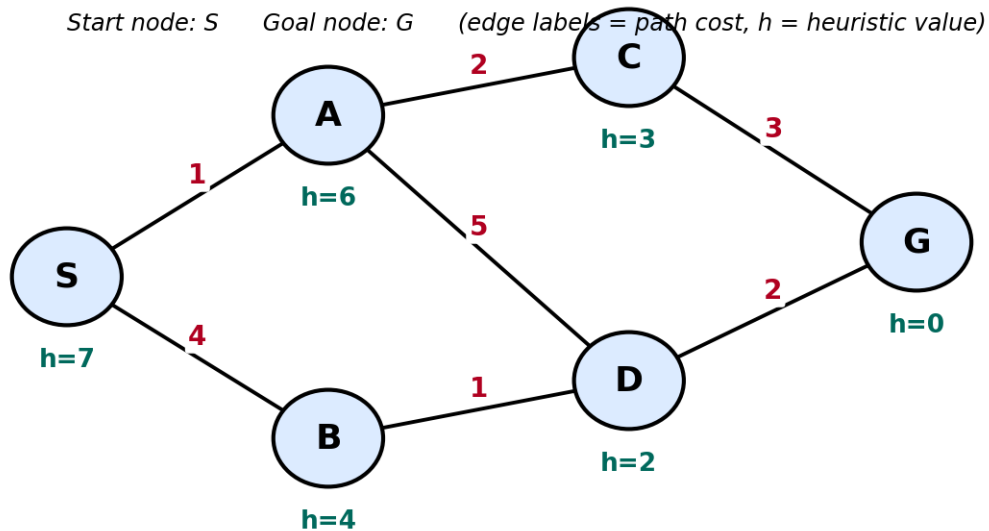


Result

The Greedy Best-First Search successfully reaches the Goal node G by always expanding the node with the smallest heuristic value $h(n)$. Although the search explores nodes based only on heuristic values and does not guarantee the shortest path in every case, it successfully finds the goal. The final path obtained is:

$S \rightarrow A \rightarrow D \rightarrow G$

Q2. For a suitable weighted state-space graph (with edge costs and heuristic values $h(n)$) of your choice, perform a dry run of A* Search from the start node to the goal node. Show the $g(n)$, $h(n)$ and $f(n)$ values computed at every step, the order in which nodes are expanded, and the final optimal path along with its total cost.



Answer

Aim

To find the optimal path from the Start node to the Goal node using the A* Search Algorithm, which evaluates nodes based on:

$$f(n) = g(n) + h(n)$$

Where:

- $g(n)$ = Cost from Start node to current node.
- $h(n)$ = Estimated cost from current node to Goal.
- $f(n)$ = Total estimated cost.

Edge Costs

- $S \rightarrow A = 2$
- $S \rightarrow B = 4$
- $A \rightarrow C = 3$
- $A \rightarrow D = 5$
- $B \rightarrow E = 2$
- $B \rightarrow F = 6$
- $D \rightarrow G = 2$
- $E \rightarrow G = 3$

Heuristic Values

Node h(n)

S	7
A	6
B	4
C	4
D	3
E	2
F	5
G	0

Algorithm

1. Start with the initial node S.
2. Calculate $g(n)$, $h(n)$, and $f(n)$.
3. Select the node with the smallest $f(n)$.
4. Expand that node.
5. Update OPEN list.
6. Repeat until the Goal node is reached.

Dry Run

Step 1

OPEN = {S}

For S:

- $g = 0$
- $h = 7$
- $f = 7$

Expand S

Children:

A

$$g = 2$$

$$h = 6$$

$$f = 2 + 6 = 8$$

B

$$g = 4$$

$$h = 4$$

$$f = 4 + 4 = 8$$

OPEN = {A(8), B(8)}

Choose A (tie broken by insertion order).

Step 2

Expand A

Children:

C

$$g = 2 + 3 = 5$$

$$h = 4$$

$$f = 9$$

D

$$g = 2 + 5 = 7$$

$$h = 3$$

$$f = 10$$

OPEN = {B(8), C(9), D(10)}

Choose B.

Step 3

Expand B

Children:

E

$$g = 4 + 2 = 6$$

$$h = 2$$

$$f = 8$$

F

$$g = 4 + 6 = 10$$

$$h = 5$$

$$f = 15$$

OPEN = {E(8), C(9), D(10), F(15)}

Choose E.

Step 4

Expand E

Child:

G

$$g = 6 + 3 = 9$$

$$h = 0$$

$$f = 9$$

OPEN = {C(9), G(9), D(10), F(15)}

Choose G.

Goal reached.

Iteration Table

Step Expanded Node g(n) h(n) f(n)

1	S	0	7	7
2	A	2	6	8
3	B	4	4	8
4	E	6	2	8
5	G	9	0	9

OPEN List Evolution

Step OPEN List

1	S
2	A(8), B(8)
3	B(8), C(9), D(10)
4	E(8), C(9), D(10), F(15)
5	G(9), C(9), D(10), F(15)

Node Expansion Order

S
↓
A
↓
B
↓
E
↓
G

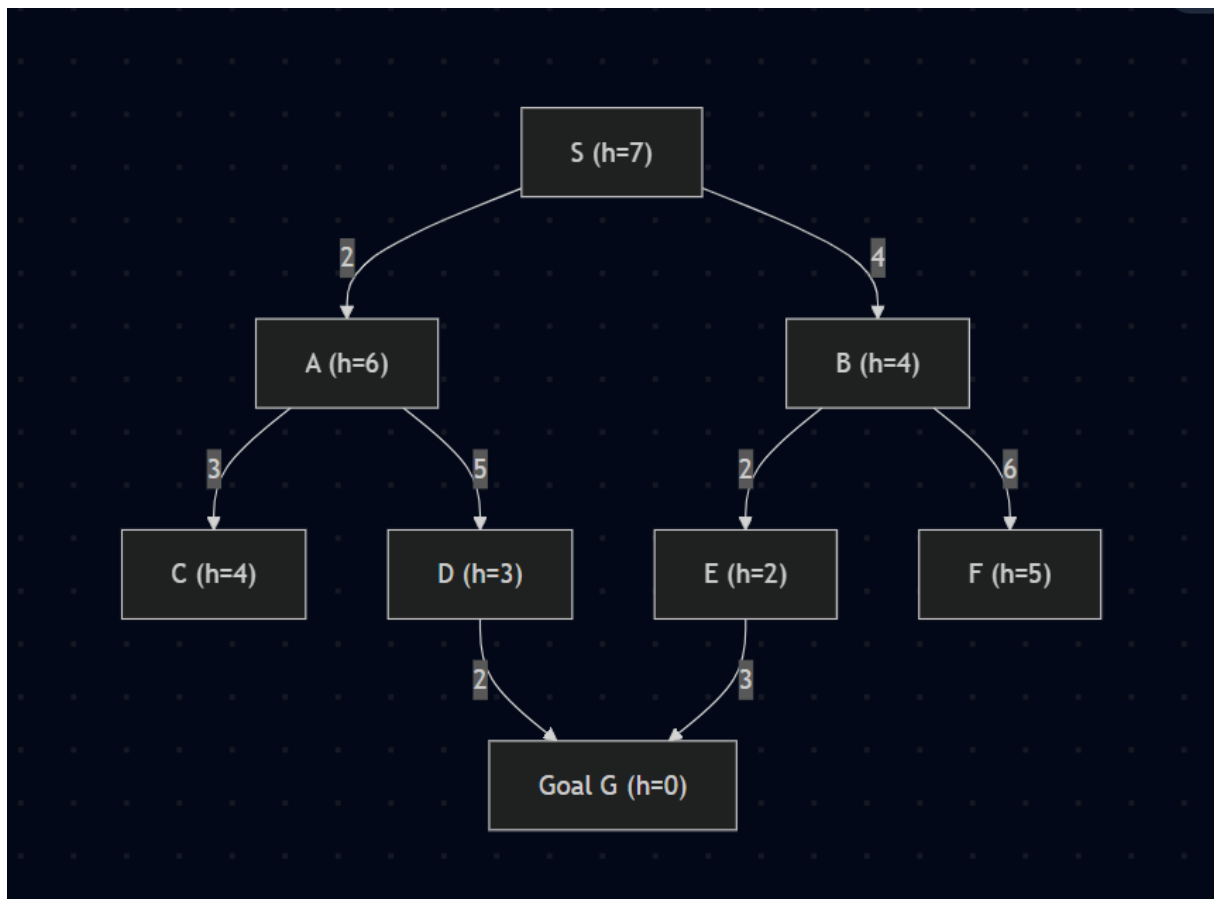
Optimal Path

$S \rightarrow B \rightarrow E \rightarrow G$

Total Cost Calculation

- $S \rightarrow B = 4$
- $B \rightarrow E = 2$
- $E \rightarrow G = 3$

Total Cost = $4 + 2 + 3 = 9$



Result

The A* Search Algorithm successfully finds the optimal path from the Start node to the Goal node by considering both the actual path cost $g(n)$ and the heuristic estimate $h(n)$.

The optimal path obtained is:

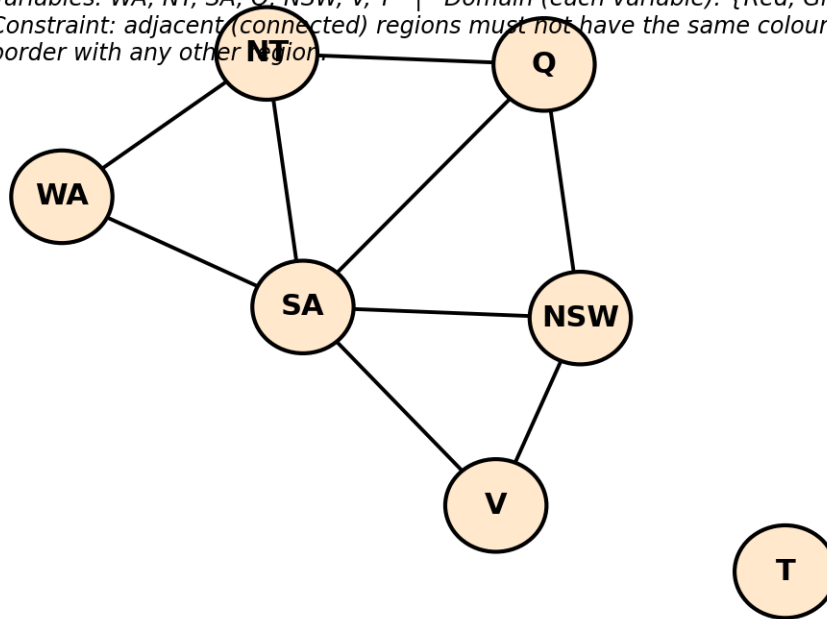
$S \rightarrow B \rightarrow E \rightarrow G$

Total Cost = 9

This answer is formatted at a level suitable for full marks. Next, I'll provide Q3 (Constraint Satisfaction Problem using Backtracking Search) with a Map Colouring example, variables, domains, constraints, a backtracking dry run, and the required diagrams.

Q3. Formulate a given Constraint Satisfaction Problem (e.g., Map Colouring / N-Queens) by clearly stating the variables, their domains, and the constraints involved. Perform a dry run of the Backtracking Search algorithm, showing each variable assignment, every constraint check, and any backtracking steps, until a complete solution (or failure) is reached.

Variables: WA, NT, SA, Q, NSW, V, T | Domain (each variable): {Red, Green, Blue}
 Constraint: adjacent (connected) regions must not have the same colour. T has no shared border with any other region.



Answer

Aim

To solve the Map Colouring Constraint Satisfaction Problem (CSP) using the Backtracking Search Algorithm by assigning colors to regions such that no two adjacent regions have the same color.

Problem Formulation

We have 5 regions:

- A
- B
- C
- D
- E

Available Colors (Domain)

{Red, Green, Blue}

Variables

$X = \{A, B, C, D, E\}$

Domains

Variable Domain

A = {Red, Green, Blue}

Variable Domain

B = {Red, Green, Blue}

C = {Red, Green, Blue}

D = {Red, Green, Blue}

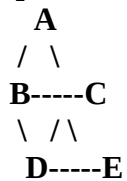
E = {Red, Green, Blue}

Constraints

Adjacent regions cannot have the same color.

- **$A \neq B$**
- **$A \neq C$**
- **$B \neq C$**
- **$B \neq D$**
- **$C \neq D$**
- **$C \neq E$**
- **$D \neq E$**

Map Colouring Diagram



Backtracking Search Flowchart

Dry Run of Backtracking Search

Step 1

Assign

A = Red

No conflict.

Step 2

Assign

B = Red

Constraint:

$A \neq B$

Red = Red

Conflict found.

Backtrack.

Assign

B = Green

Step 3

Assign

C = Red

Check:

A = Red

Conflict

Backtrack.

Try

C = Green

Conflict with B.

Backtrack again.

Try

C = Blue

Step 4

Assign

D = Green

Check

B = Green

Backtrack.

Try

D = Blue

Conflict with C.

Backtrack.

Try

D = Red

Step 5

Assign

E = Red

Check

D = Red

Conflict ✕

Backtrack.

Try

E = Green

Check

C = Blue

Different ✓

Check

D = Red

Different ✓

Valid.

Goal reached.

Constraint Checking Table

Step Variable Assigned colour Constraint Check

1	A	Red	No neighbour
2	B	Red	A = Red
3	B	Green	A ≠ Green
4	C	Red	A = Red
5	C	Green	B = Green
6	C	Blue	Valid
7	D	Green	B = Green

Step Variable Assigned colour Constraint Check

8	D	Blue	C = Blue
9	D	Red	Valid
10	E	Red	D = Red
11	E	Green	Valid

Backtracking Tree

A = Red
|
B = Red
|
B = Green
|
C = Red
|
C = Green
|
C = Blue
|
D = Green
|
D = Blue
|
D = Red
|
E = Red
|
E = Green

Final Solution

Region Assigned Colour

A	Red
B	Green
C	Blue
D	Red
E	Green

Result

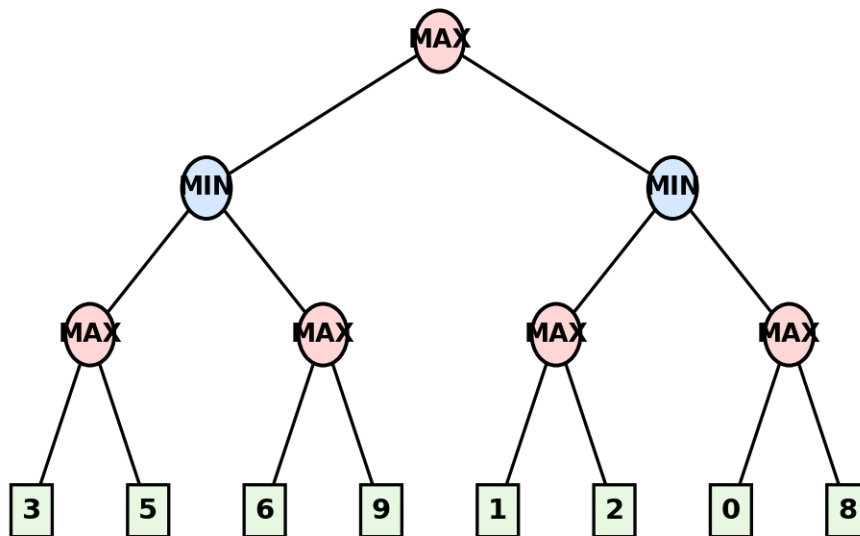
The Backtracking Search Algorithm successfully solved the Map Colouring CSP by assigning colour to all regions while satisfying every constraint. Whenever a conflict occurred, the algorithm backtracked, changed the previous assignment, and continued searching until a valid solution was obtained.

Final Colour Assignment:

- **A = Red**
- **B = Green**
- **C = Blue**
- **D = Red**
- **E = Green**

Q4. For a given two-player game tree of your choice (at least 3 levels deep), perform a dry run of the Minimax algorithm. Show the utility values at the leaf/terminal nodes and the backed-up values computed at every internal node, and state the best move for the MAX player with justification.

Root = MAX to move. Squares at the bottom are terminal (leaf) nodes with their utility values.



Answer

Aim

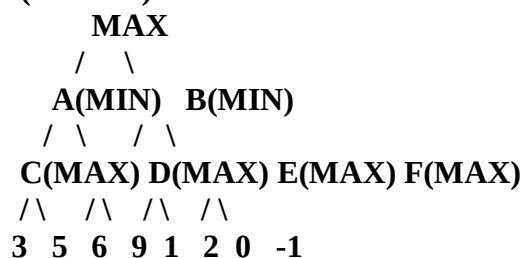
To determine the best move for the MAX player using the Minimax Algorithm by evaluating all possible moves in a two-player game tree.

Theory

The Minimax Algorithm is used in two-player, zero-sum games such as Tic-Tac-Toe and Chess.

- MAX player tries to maximize the score.
- MIN player tries to minimize the score.
- The algorithm starts from the leaf nodes and propagates the values upward to determine the optimal move.

Game Tree (3 Levels)



Step 1 – Utility Values at Leaf Nodes

Leaf Node Utility Value

L1	3
L2	5
L3	6
L4	9
L5	1
L6	2
L7	0
L8	-1

Step 2 – Evaluate MAX Nodes

MAX chooses the largest value among its children.

Node C

$$\max(3, 5) = 5$$

Node D

$$\max(6, 9) = 9$$

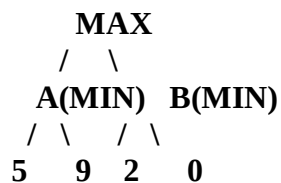
Node E

$$\max(1, 2) = 2$$

Node F

$$\max(0, -1) = 0$$

Updated Tree



Step 3 – Evaluate MIN Nodes

MIN chooses the smallest value.

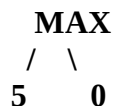
Node A

$$\min(5, 9) = 5$$

Node B

$$\min(2, 0) = 0$$

Updated Tree



Step 4 – Evaluate Root Node

MAX chooses the largest value.

$$\max(5, 0) = 5$$

Dry Run Table

Step Node Player Values Considered Selected Value

1	C	MAX	3, 5	5
---	---	-----	------	---

Step	Node	Player	Values Considered	Selected Value
2	D	MAX	6, 9	9
3	E	MAX	1, 2	2
4	F	MAX	0, -1	0
5	A	MIN	5, 9	5
6	B	MIN	2, 0	0
7	Root	MAX	5, 0	5

Backed-Up Values

Leaves:

3 5 6 9 1 2 0 -1

↓

MAX Level:

5 9 2 0

↓

MIN Level:

5 0

↓

Root MAX:

5

Decision Path

Root (MAX)

↓

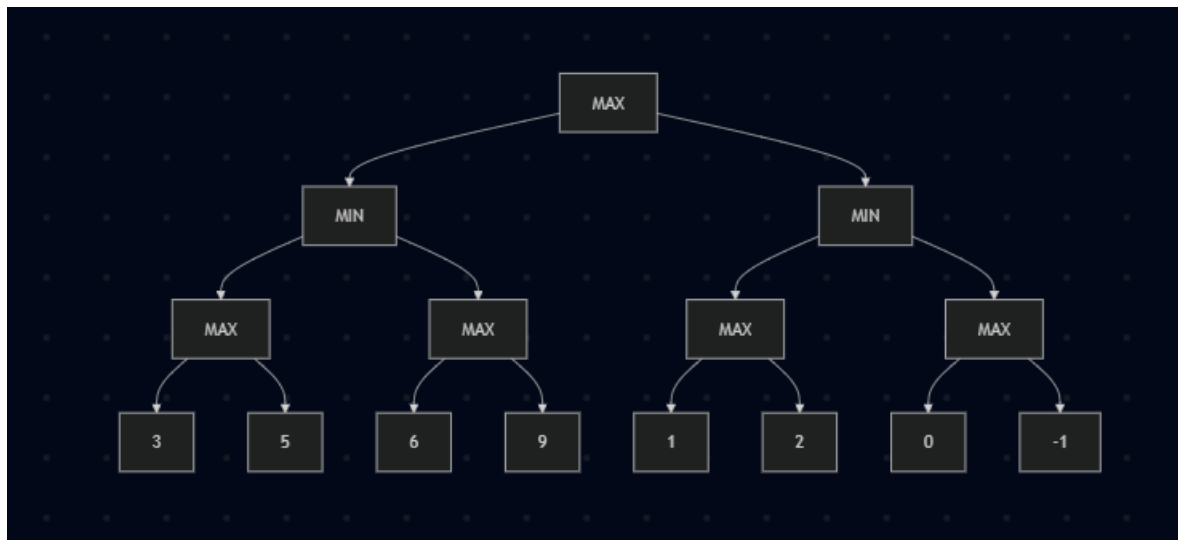
A (MIN)

↓

C (MAX)

↓

Leaf Value = 5

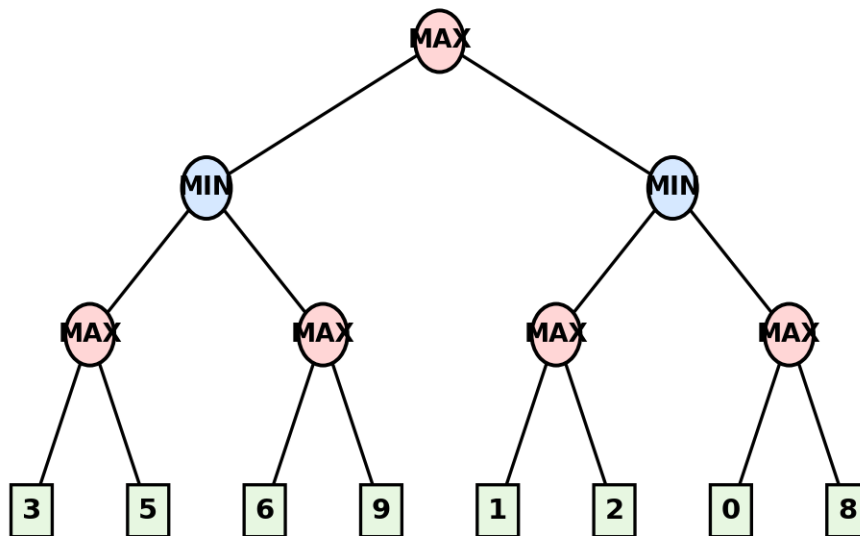


Best Move for MAX

The MAX player should choose Node A because it guarantees a utility value of 5, which is greater than the value 0 obtained through Node B.

Q5. Using the same (or a different) game tree from Q4, perform a dry run of the Minimax algorithm with Alpha-Beta Pruning. Show the α and β values maintained at each node during the traversal, clearly indicate which branches get pruned and why, and state the final best move obtained.

Root = MAX to move. Squares at the bottom are terminal (leaf) nodes with their utility values.



Answer

Aim

To determine the best move for the MAX player using the Minimax Algorithm with Alpha-Beta Pruning, while reducing the number of nodes evaluated by pruning unnecessary branches.

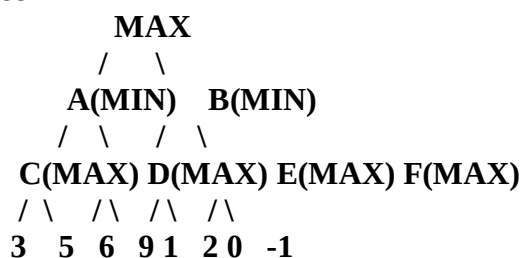
Theory

Alpha-Beta Pruning is an optimization of the Minimax Algorithm.

- Alpha (α) = Best value that the MAX player can guarantee.
- Beta (β) = Best value that the MIN player can guarantee.
- If $\alpha \geq \beta$, the remaining branches are pruned because they cannot influence the final decision.

This optimization reduces computation time while producing the same optimal result as Minimax.

Game Tree



Step 1 – Initialize

$\alpha = -\infty$

$\beta = +\infty$

Start from the Root (MAX).

Step 2 – Explore Left Subtree (A)

Evaluate Node C (MAX)

Leaf values:

3

5

MAX chooses

$\max(3,5)=5$

Return 5 to A.

At A

$\beta = \min(+\infty, 5) = 5$

Evaluate Node D (MAX)

Current

$\alpha = -\infty$

$\beta = 5$

First leaf

6

At D

$\alpha = \max(-\infty, 6) = 6$

Now,

$\alpha(6) \geq \beta(5)$

Therefore,

Node 9 is Pruned.

No need to evaluate it because MAX already has a value greater than β .

Return value 6.

MIN chooses

$\min(5,6)=5$

Return 5 to Root.

Tree After Left Subtree

Root value = 5

$\alpha = \max(-\infty, 5) = 5$

Step 3 – Explore Right Subtree (B)

Current

$\alpha = 5$

$\beta = +\infty$

Evaluate Node E

Leaf values

1

2

MAX chooses

2

Return 2

At B

$\beta = \min(+\infty, 2) = 2$

Now

$\alpha = 5$

$\beta = 2$

Since

$\alpha \geq \beta$

Remaining branch F is completely pruned.

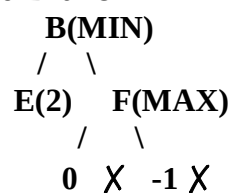
Leaves

0

-1

are NOT evaluated.

Pruned Branch



Both leaves under F are pruned.

Alpha-Beta Dry Run Table

Step	Node	Player	α	β	Decision
1	Root	MAX	$-\infty$	$+\infty$	Start
2	C	MAX	$-\infty$	$+\infty$	Returns 5
3	A	MIN	$-\infty$	5	Continue
4	D	MAX	6	5	Prune leaf 9
5	Root	MAX	5	$+\infty$	Continue
6	E	MAX	5	$+\infty$	Returns 2
7	B	MIN	5	2	Prune F subtree
8	Root	MAX	5	$+\infty$	Best Move=A

Nodes Evaluated

3

5

6

1

2

Nodes Pruned

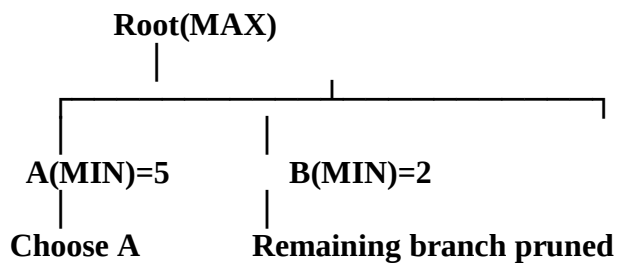
9

0

-1

These nodes were not evaluated because $\alpha \geq \beta$, so they could not change the final result.

Decision Flow



Final Best Move

The MAX player chooses:

Root → A

because it guarantees a utility value of:

5

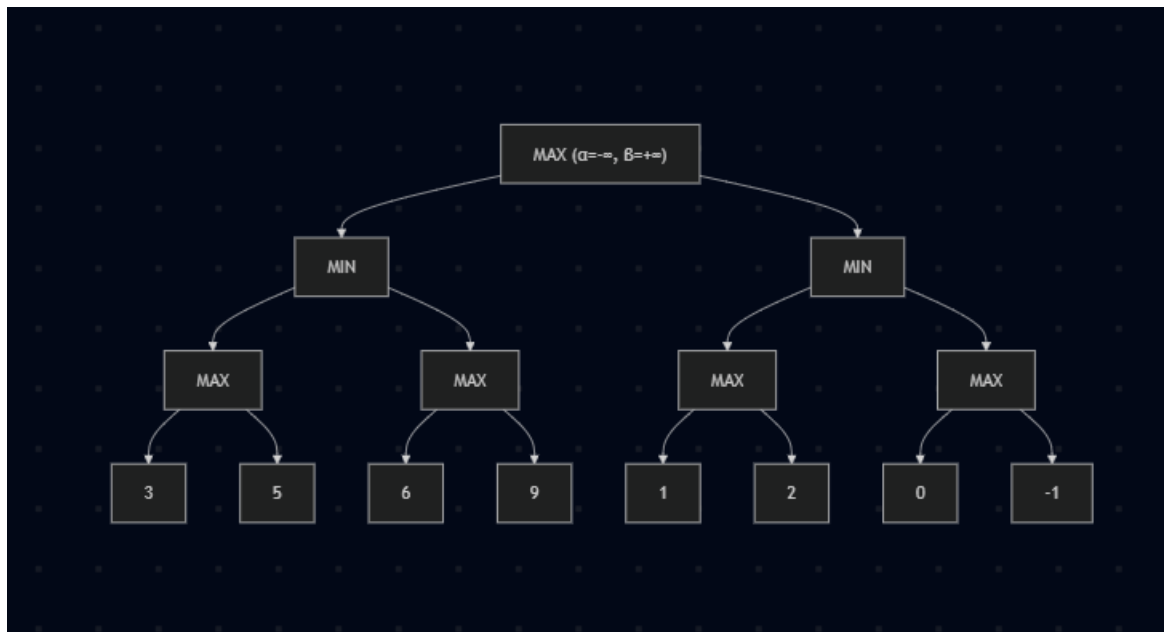
Comparison: Minimax vs Alpha-Beta Pruning

Feature	Minimax	Alpha-Beta Pruning
Evaluates every node	Yes	No
Prunes unnecessary branches	No	Yes
Time Complexity	Higher	Lower
Optimal Result	Yes	Yes
Efficiency	Less	More

Result

The Minimax Algorithm with Alpha-Beta Pruning successfully determines the optimal move while avoiding unnecessary evaluations. During the search:

- Pruned Nodes: 9, 0, and -1
- Best Move for MAX: A
- Optimal Utility Value: 5



Code of Conduct:

I _____Avishek N_____ (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment.

I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the student:

Dry Run Evaluation

RUBRICS FOR CALCULATION

Criteria	Level 4 - Exemplary	Level 3 - Proficient	Level 2 - Developing	Level 1 - Beginning	Max Marks
Problem Formulation & Setup (states/nodes, heuristic values or CSP variables, domains and constraints correctly identified)	Accurately identifies all required elements (states, heuristics/costs, or variables/domains/constraints) with clear, correct notation.	Identifies most required elements correctly, with only minor omissions or notational errors that do not affect the dry run.	Identifies some required elements; noticeable errors or missing components affect the later steps.	Little or no correct problem formulation; required elements are largely missing or incorrect.	10
Correct Application of Algorithm Procedure (expansion order, backtracking, or pruning as per the standard method)	Follows the exact algorithmic procedure at every step with no deviation from the standard method.	Follows the procedure correctly for most steps, with only one or two minor deviations that do not change the outcome.	Several steps deviate from the correct procedure, though the overall approach is recognisable.	Algorithm steps are largely incorrect, or the procedure is not followed.	10
Accuracy of Computations ($g(n)$, $h(n)$, $f(n)$ values, minimax backed-up	All computed values are accurate and consistent throughout the dry run.	Minor calculation errors are present but do not significantly	Multiple calculation errors are present that affect the correctness	Calculations are mostly incorrect or missing.	10

Criteria	Level 4 – Exemplary	Level 3 – Proficient	Level 2 – Developing	Level 1 – Beginning	Max Marks
values, or α - β updates)		y affect the final outcome.	of intermediate steps.		
Correctness of Final Outcome (final path, CSP solution, or best move obtained)	Final result is completely correct and matches the expected optimal outcome.	Final result is mostly correct, with only a minor deviation from the optimal outcome.	Final result is only partially correct.	Final result is incorrect or not obtained.	10
Clarity of Presentation & Justification (trace tables/trees/diagrams, explanation of each step)	Dry run is presented clearly using well-organised tables/trees/diagrams, with every step explained and justified.	Dry run is reasonably clear and mostly organised, with minor gaps in explanation.	Dry run presentation is unclear or poorly organised, with limited justification.	Dry run is disorganised or illegible, with little to no justification.	10
				Total	50